

# Copilot Licensing & Deployment

Field cheat sheet: who gets what, what it costs, and how to roll out without overwhelming the team.

## THE MODEL

TIER 1 · FRONT DOOR

Copilot Chat

Free, included

Web-grounded, enterprise data protection. Safe to give broadly.

TIER 2 · PAID SEAT

Microsoft 365 Copilot

~\$30/user/mo\*

Grounds on your data, in-app editing, zero-rates most agent use.

USAGE LAYER

Cowork & agents

Usage-billed

On a paid seat, off until an admin turns it on.

No “Copilot Premium” SKU to buy — it is just an in-app label for the paid seat.

## WHO GETS WHAT, BY ROLE

| ROLE                  | RECOMMENDED TIER      | PAYS EXTRA FOR         |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|
| Director / Exec       | Paid seat             | Cowork                 |
| Manager               | Paid seat             | Cowork                 |
| Analyst               | Paid seat             | Cowork, Studio         |
| Knowledge worker      | Start free → paid     | Paid seat when engaged |
| Engineer / Dev        | GitHub Copilot + seat | Studio, Azure          |
| Frontline (F-plan)    | Free Chat if eligible | Add-on on F1/F3        |
| Security / Compliance | Security Copilot      | Per product terms      |

## GOVERN FIRST (STEP ZERO)

PEOPLE

AI governance committee, an executive sponsor, champions, and culture set from the top.

PLATFORM

SharePoint Advanced Mgmt (included) + RCD, Purview, and the Agent Registry / Agent 365.

## DO THIS NEXT

- 1

Stand up the AI governance committee and name the sponsor.
- 2

Turn on free Chat (handle web search for PHI-heavy groups first).
- 3

Buy a focused block of paid seats (dozens, not thousands).
- 4

Fix oversharing, then stand up the Agent Registry.
- 5

Let a governed few build agents; let everyone use approved ones.

**The one budget fact** Paid seats make most employee-facing agent use free. Free-Chat users pay per interaction (~\$0.01 per credit). That single split drives the whole budget.

## COMPLIANCE GUARDRAILS

WEEK 1

Disable OpenAI-operated models if you require HITRUST, SOC 1, or FedRAMP High.

WEEKS 1–4

Move oversharing control to Restricted Content Discovery as legacy search retires.

ONGOING

Confirm Anthropic / EU Data Boundary BAA coverage before PHI-adjacent Cowork or Researcher use.

**BAA covers Copilot + Chat.** Web search is the exception — keep PHI out of web-grounded prompts. Dragon Copilot is the separate product for clinical documentation.